

Use a blunder check on the future board

Thinking And Training

THE IDEA

A final blunder check examines the position after your intended move. Visualize the piece leaving its old square and arriving at its destination. New lines and abandoned defenders are common sources of mistakes.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Moving a knight to attack the queen may uncover a rook attack on your own king. Even if the knight's destination is safe, the move can be illegal or lose material because of what it stopped defending.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

Which three questions belong in the final scan?

ANSWER AND REASONING

Can the opponent check, capture something valuable, or create an immediate forcing threat? Include attacks revealed by your move and defenders you have removed.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Inspect what your move exposes, not only what it attacks.